

FA0001_Cycle_Researcher.pdf COMPLETED

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Search

CONSENSUS SCORE

1/6

Confidence 5/5

QUALITY	1/4
CLARITY	1/4
SIGNIFICANCE	1/4
ORIGINALITY	1/4

REVIEWERS

Consensus	1/6
GPT 5.4	2/6
Gemini 3.1 Pro	1/6
Claude Opus 4.6	1/6

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Consensus review synthesized from 3 independent reviewers

Consensus	GPT 5.4	Gemini 3.1 Pro	Claude Opus 4...
1/6	2/6	1/6	1/6

SUMMARY

All reviewers agree that the submission is not publishable in its current form, and the verified context strongly supports that conclusion. The central consensus is that the paper is fundamentally incomplete: the main results and ablation sections are empty, the method is described only at a very high level, and the abstract/conclusion make empirical claims that are unsupported anywhere in the manuscript. Reviewers also agree that the paper's scholarly apparatus is severely unreliable, with fabricated terminology (most notably "underwear governmenting"), malformed citation artifacts (e.g., "202" and "?"), several badly misdescribed references, unverifiable dataset names/attributions, and conceptual confusion between emergent misalignment and the alignment tax. The main divergence is only in calibration: Reviewer 1 gives slight credit for a possibly distinct high-level idea and is one point more generous on originality and overall score, while Reviewers 2 and 3 treat originality as effectively unassessable and recommend a stronger rejection. I side with the harsher consensus because the paper does not provide enough scientific content to substantiate even its basic claims. One factual nuance relative to the harsher reviews: the bibliography is not entirely fabricated—some references are real and in a few cases correctly described (e.g., InstructGPT, PPO, Betley 2025, BLOCK-EM, SafeLoRA, CycleResearcher)—but the overall citation and attribution quality remains far below scholarly standards.

STRENGTHS

The paper targets an important and timely problem: preventing harmful or broadly misaligned behavior during or after fine-tuning without sacrificing benign capabilities. The manuscript also appears to intend a potentially interesting direction at a very high level—dynamically adjusting internal instruction representations, possibly combined with benign-data augmentation. In addition, the submission explicitly discloses substantial use of CycleResearcher/LLM assistance, which is more transparent than failing to disclose such tooling. Finally, despite major citation problems, the paper is at least nominally grounded in some real and relevant prior work, including InstructGPT, PPO,

WEAKNESSES

The weaknesses are fatal. First, there is no empirical evidence: verified inspection shows Sections 6.1 and 6.2 contain only placeholder sentences and no tables, figures, numbers, or comparisons, despite the abstract and conclusion claiming extensive experiments and decomposition analyses. Second, the methodology is far too incomplete to evaluate: Section 4 is only a few high-level sentences and lacks equations, pseudocode, architecture, objective functions, intervention location, hyperparameters, or implementation details; the reproducibility statement is contradicted by the actual content. Third, the paper's scholarship is deeply unreliable. The title and body use the

emergent misalignment, BLOCK-EM, and SafeLoRA.

governmenting," falsely attributing it to BLOCK-EM; the paper contains systematic broken citation artifacts such as "202" and a literal "?" placeholder; and multiple real papers are misdescribed, including rsLoRA, LDIFS, MACHIAVELLI, Baker 2025, WildGuard, and likely Chua 2025. Fourth, the experimental setup is not trustworthy because several named datasets or suites (e.g., Security EM, MMoCA, DangerousQA, Security Arithmetic) could not be independently verified as described. Fifth, the conceptual framing is confused: the paper conflates emergent misalignment with the alignment tax, which are distinct phenomena in the literature. Overall, the submission reads less like a completed scientific paper than an inadequately checked automated draft.

QUESTIONS FOR AUTHORS

Please provide the full DIRA method: equations, pseudocode, loss terms, model components, and the exact transformer location where representation adjustment occurs.

What is the "dynamic policy" concretely, and what is the role of the claimed "latent diffusion prior" in an LLM safety setting?

Where are the actual experimental results and ablations that are claimed in the abstract and conclusion?

What are the exact datasets, baselines, prompts, metrics, judges, and model variants used? Please clarify the status of names such as Security EM, MMoCA, DangerousQA, Security Arithmetic, and "Instruct-LoRA."

Please audit every citation and attribution, especially the uses of "underwear governmenting," "202," and "?", and correct the misdescriptions of rsLoRA, LDIFS, MACHIAVELLI, Baker 2025, WildGuard, and related work.

Please correct the conceptual framing of emergent misalignment versus alignment tax and present a consistent end-to-end training pipeline.

This assessment is constrained by the submission's incompleteness. Because the method and results are largely absent, there is limited ability to evaluate technical merit beyond identifying the missing scientific content and factual errors. Some reviewer observations about internal inconsistencies beyond the verified findings may depend on manuscript interpretation, but the central rejection reasons do not: the missing experiments, incomplete method, fabricated terminology, broken citations, and multiple misdescribed references are directly supported by the provided context.

DIMENSION ANALYSIS

Quality

1/4

All three reviewers assigned the lowest quality score, and the verified facts support that unanimity. The paper makes strong performance and safety claims without any actual reported experiments; Sections 6.1 and 6.2 are empty. The method is not specified at a level that would permit evaluation or reproduction: there is no formal algorithm, no mathematical objective, no implementation detail, and no clear operational role for the claimed "latent diffusion prior" or dynamic policy. The paper also contains numerous factual and bibliographic errors, further undermining trust in the technical claims. This is a clear score of 1.

Clarity

1/4

All reviewers scored clarity as 1, which is appropriate. While some sentences are superficially fluent, scientific clarity is extremely poor because the paper omits the crucial content needed to understand or reproduce the work. The title contains nonsensical fabricated terminology; the method and evaluation are underspecified; citation syntax is broken in multiple places; and the paper includes contradictory or unverifiable descriptions of prior work and datasets. The result is a manuscript that is readable at the sentence level but not interpretable as a coherent scientific contribution.

Significance

1/4

All reviewers scored significance as 1, and I agree. The problem area is important, but significance must be based on realized contribution, not intended topic. Because the paper provides no results, no credible method specification, and no trustworthy experimental setup, it does not currently advance the field or provide a usable basis for follow-on work.

Originality

1/4

This is the only dimension with mild reviewer divergence (scores 2, 1, 1), so by the requested rule the median is 1. Reviewer 1 saw some possible conceptual novelty in the idea of dynamically adjusting internal representations of harmful instructions plus benign-data augmentation. That is a fair observation at the level of intent. However, the verified context shows that the method is described in only a handful of vague sentences, with no formal mechanism, no ablations, and no credible comparison to adjacent approaches such as BLOCK-EM or SafeLoRA. In scientific-review terms, the claimed novelty is not established well enough to merit more than minimal credit. I therefore assign originality = 1.

ETHICAL CONCERNS

Yes. The main concern is not merely that AI tools were used—the paper discloses substantial use of CycleResearcher—but that the manuscript makes unsupported claims of experimental

misdeshribes or corrupts citations. In a safety-related paper, claiming improved robustness without presenting evidence is itself a serious research-integrity concern.